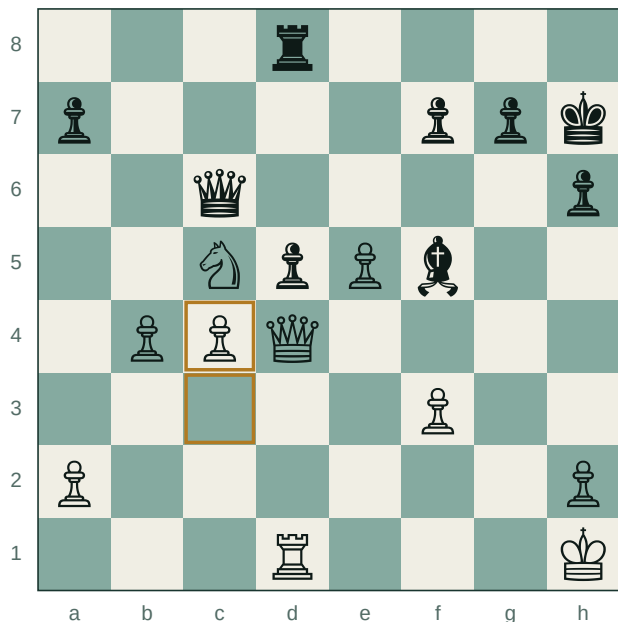


Pins and pressure: Black, move 41

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 41.c4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

41...dxc4 42. Qxd8 Qxf3+

41...dxc4 The pawn captures the pawn on c4. The changed line means the rook on d8 attacks the queen on d4.
Recorded reply: **42.Qxd8**.

42...Qxf3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. From f3 it attacks king on h1 and rook on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by -3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: -3:** the balance goes from -1 to -4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on h1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.